

Project Implementation Phases

Description

The development of the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System** follows a structured six-phase implementation methodology. Each phase focuses on a specific aspect of the solution, ensuring that the system is planned, configured, tested, and deployed systematically using native ServiceNow capabilities.

This phased approach minimizes implementation risks, improves solution quality, and ensures that all business and technical requirements are successfully achieved.

Phase 1: Requirement Analysis & Planning

Overview

The first phase focuses on understanding the business problem of recurring SLA violations and identifying organizational requirements for a proactive SLA governance solution. Stakeholders are consulted to gather functional and non-functional requirements, define project objectives, and establish the project scope.

During this phase, the implementation strategy is planned to ensure that the solution can be developed using zero-code ServiceNow features while meeting enterprise governance standards.

Activities

- Analyze the existing SLA management process.
- Identify challenges related to SLA breaches.
- Gather business and technical requirements.
- Define project objectives and expected outcomes.
- Identify stakeholders and user roles.
- Prepare functional and non-functional requirements.
- Define project scope and implementation roadmap.

Deliverables

- Requirements Specification Document
- Stakeholder Analysis
- Project Scope
- Functional Requirements

- Non-Functional Requirements
 - Project Plan
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Phase 2: Backend Configuration & Data Setup

Overview

This phase involves configuring the core ServiceNow components required for SLA governance. Incident records, SLA definitions, custom fields, access controls, and supporting configurations are prepared to enable automated monitoring and governance.

The backend configuration establishes the foundation for all subsequent automation and user interactions.

Activities

- Configure Incident Resolution SLA.
- Create custom SLA governance fields.
- Configure SLA monitoring conditions.
- Set up Role-Based Access Control (RBAC).
- Configure Access Control Lists (ACLs).
- Prepare sample incident records for testing.
- Validate backend configurations.

Deliverables

- Configured Incident Management
 - SLA Configuration
 - Custom Fields
 - ACL Configuration
 - Backend Data Setup
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Phase 3: Notification Configuration using Flow Designer & UI Policy Creation

Overview

The third phase focuses on automating SLA governance through Flow Designer and UI Policies. Automated workflows detect incidents nearing SLA breach and notify assigned users, while UI Policies enforce mandatory governance fields.

These configurations ensure proactive communication and standardized documentation without requiring custom scripting.

Activities

- Design Flow Designer workflows.
- Configure SLA warning email notifications.
- Define SLA risk conditions.
- Create UI Policies.
- Configure mandatory governance fields.
- Test automated notification flow.
- Validate policy enforcement.

Deliverables

- Flow Designer Workflow
- Email Notifications
- UI Policies
- Mandatory Field Validation
- Automated Governance Process

Phase 4: Virtual Agent Design

Overview

In this phase, the ServiceNow Virtual Agent is designed to provide a conversational interface that guides users through SLA awareness and governance activities. The chatbot educates users about SLA risks, captures acknowledgements, and assists in completing the required breach documentation.

The Virtual Agent enhances user engagement by replacing manual reminders with interactive conversations.

Activities

- Create Virtual Agent conversation topics.

- Design conversation flow.
- Configure user prompts.
- Capture SLA acknowledgement.
- Collect breach reason and justification.
- Test conversation scenarios.
- Validate chatbot functionality.

Deliverables

- Virtual Agent Topic
 - Conversation Flow
 - User Guidance Messages
 - SLA Acknowledgement Process
 - Chatbot Testing Results
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Phase 5: Reporting & Dashboards

Overview

This phase develops real-time reports and dashboards that provide visibility into SLA governance activities. Managers can monitor SLA compliance, analyze breach trends, and evaluate team performance using interactive visualizations.

The reporting solution supports operational monitoring as well as executive decision-making.

Activities

- Create SLA compliance reports.
- Develop breach analysis reports.
- Build justification tracking reports.
- Configure performance dashboards.
- Design management dashboards.
- Validate report accuracy.

Deliverables

- SLA Compliance Reports

- Breach Analysis Reports
 - Assignee Performance Reports
 - Governance Dashboard
 - Executive Dashboard
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Phase 6: Testing & Validation

Overview

The final phase verifies that all system components function correctly and meet the defined business requirements. End-to-end testing is performed to validate automation, security, Virtual Agent interactions, notifications, reporting, and overall system performance.

This phase ensures that the solution is reliable, secure, and ready for deployment.

Activities

- Perform functional testing.
- Validate SLA monitoring.
- Test Flow Designer notifications.
- Test Virtual Agent conversations.
- Verify UI Policy behavior.
- Validate Role-Based Access Control.
- Test reports and dashboards.
- Conduct user acceptance testing (UAT).
- Document testing outcomes.

Deliverables

- Test Cases
- Test Execution Report
- Defect Log
- Validation Report
- User Acceptance Testing Report
- Final Project Documentation

Phase Summary

Phase	Objective	Key Deliverables
Phase 1	Requirement Analysis & Planning	Requirements document, project scope, stakeholder analysis
Phase 2	Backend Configuration & Data Setup	SLA configuration, custom fields, RBAC, backend setup
Phase 3	Notification Configuration using Flow Designer & UI Policy Creation	Automated notifications, UI Policies, governance automation
Phase 4	Virtual Agent Design	Conversation topics, chatbot workflows, SLA acknowledgement
Phase 5	Reporting & Dashboards	Reports, dashboards, performance analytics
Phase 6	Testing & Validation	Test reports, validation documents, UAT, deployment readiness

Conclusion

The six-phase implementation approach provides a structured framework for developing the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. Beginning with thorough requirement analysis and ending with comprehensive testing and validation, each phase contributes to building a reliable, scalable, and audit-ready SLA governance solution. By leveraging native ServiceNow features such as Flow Designer, Virtual Agent, UI Policies, reporting, and role-based access control, the project delivers a proactive and efficient mechanism for improving SLA compliance, strengthening accountability, and enhancing overall service management.